Word order

Mostly like English: who, does, what. The big difference is where the describing words go.

ADJECTIVES USUALLY COME AFTER THE NOUN

la casa **blanca**

the white house

un vuelo **largo**

a long flight

A FEW COME BEFORE, AND SOME CHANGE MEANING

un **buen** día

a good day (bueno → buen before a masculine noun)

un **gran** hombre · un hombre **grande**

a great man · a big man

un **viejo** amigo · un amigo **viejo**

a friend of many years · an elderly friend

THE REST OF THE SENTENCE

Lo compré.

I bought it. (the pronoun goes before the verb)

No lo sé.

I don't know. (no goes before the verb and its pronouns)

¿Dónde vive Ana?

Where does Ana live? (the subject can follow the verb)

Vamos mañana.

We're going tomorrow. (who is often left out)

Rule of thumb: an adjective after the noun sorts it from others (la casa blanca, not the blue one). Before the noun it often adds feeling or a different sense (un gran amigo).

SOURCES

- RAE–ASALE, Nueva gramática básica de la lengua española (2011): the adjective and its position; word order in the sentence.